	Level	C2 – Describe	C3 – Explain	C4 – Analyse	VCE 1 – Interpret
	Skill focus	Say what happens	Explain effect or meaning	Link language choices to ideas or themes	Link literary, structural and stylistic features, to messages, values, and creator's intents
Fiction	**Example**	The author uses repetition to show that the tree keeps giving when it says, "And the tree was happy."	The repetition of the phrase "the tree was happy" makes the tree seem generous, encouraging the reader to feel sympathy for her.	Silverstein uses repetition of the line "And the tree was happy" to highlight the one-sided relationship, suggesting themes of sacrifice and imbalance.	By repeatedly portraying the tree as endlessly giving through the recurring motif "And the tree was happy," Silverstein invites readers to question cultural expectations around self-sacrifice in unequal relationships.
	Explanation	Simple sentence pattern: subject + verb + object. Names a language feature (🟦) and states what happens in the text. Meaning stays close to the words on the page.	Adds an effect phrase to explain how the language influences the reader (🟩). Uses evaluative words and basic cause–effect reasoning.	Links language choice, effect, and theme in one sentence. Uses analytical verbs ("highlight", "suggest") to move beyond description (🟧).	Combines language choice, ideas, and values. Analyses the author's message and connects it to broader historical, social and cultural ideas.
Persuasive	**Example**	The writer states that schools should not tell children what to eat when they argue that "schools should not control students' diets".	This statement encourages readers to agree because the claim "schools should not control students' diets" sounds confident and reasonable.	By presenting the claim "schools should not control students' diets" as an assertion, the writer reinforces the idea that parents should control children's choices.	By framing parental responsibility as "common sense", the writer promotes individual choice over institutional control, reflecting values of personal freedom.
	Explanation	Simple sentence pattern: subject + verb + object. Identifies the writer's opinion and states what is said. Meaning stays close to the claim itself. Verbs are literal ("states", "says") and ideas are concrete.	Adds an effect or reason clause to explain how the statement sounds to the reader (🟩). Begins using evaluative adjectives ("reasonable", "strong"). Uses connectives like *because* or *so* to show reader response.	Links language choice, effect, and idea in one longer sentence. Uses analytical verbs ("reinforces", "frames") to explain how wording supports an argument or viewpoint (🟧). Introduces abstract nouns such as *control*, *responsibility*, or *choice*.	Combines several ideas smoothly. Uses metalanguage and to comment on the writer's perspective. Connects language choices to purpose, values or beliefs, explaining how the reader is positioned within a broader social or cultural debate.
Film	**Example**	The film uses a long shot to show the girls walking alone.	The long shot makes the audience see how far the girls must travel, showing their bravery.	Noyce uses a long shot to highlight the girls' isolation in the vast desert, symbolising their determination and loss of freedom.	Noyce repeatedly uses wide landscape shots to contrast the beauty of the land with the cruelty of the government's control, emphasising the theme of resilience against oppression.
	Explanation	Simple sentence pattern: **subject + verb + object**. Names the **film technique** (🟦) and tells what is happening on screen. Meaning stays close to what can be seen. Verbs are literal ("shows", "uses") and ideas are concrete.	Adds a **purpose phrase** using *to + verb* to show **effect on the audience** (🟩). Starts to include short reasons or reactions. Introduces **descriptive adjectives** or **feeling words** ("brave", "alone"). Uses connectives like *because* or *so*.	Links **technique, purpose, and theme** in one longer sentence. Uses **analytical verbs** ("highlight", "symbolise") to connect the image to a bigger idea (🟧). Adds extra detail with adjectives or short relative clauses ("which shows…"). Moves from describing to explaining meaning.	Combines several ideas smoothly. Uses m**etalanguage** to comment on the director's choices. Connects film language, tone, and theme in one flowing idea. Verbs are more interpretive "emphasises" and express the director's **message or values**.

Skill Area	C2	C3	C4	VCE 1
Ideas & Themes	Recognises what happens in the text or scene. Retells key details with little interpretation.	Explains basic feelings or ideas suggested by the text. Begins linking choices to simple themes.	Connects specific language or film techniques to themes or concepts. Explains what the creator might be saying.	Analyses how choices express messages, values, or perspectives. Analyses the creator's purpose in representing social or cultural issues.
Evidence & Metalanguage	Gives a simple quote or description from the text or scene.	Names a language or film feature and begins linking it to meaning.	Uses terminology accurately with short, embedded evidence.	Integrates evidence and metalanguage fluently to build interpretation.
Language & Structure	Writes short, simple sentences using mostly literal verbs ("shows", "uses").	Expands sentences with connectives such as because, so, or to. Uses basic evaluative words.	Uses more complex sentences and analytical verbs ("suggests", "highlights").	Writes fluently in a cohesive formal style, varying sentence structures to show cause, effect, and interpretation.
Purpose & Interpretation	Identifies the basic meaning or message.	Explains the effect on the reader or viewer.	Makes inferences about the creator's intent or perspective.	Discusses deeper social, moral, or ethical ideas, linking choices to broader context.